REBECCA JACK

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Nebraska-Lincoln — 2027 (expected)
M.P.P., Brigham Young University — 2014
B.S., Mathematics, Brigham Young University, *summa cum laude* — 2012

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor and Public

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Afterschool Care Subsidies and Maternal Employment"

Abstract: Afterschool care addresses the gap between the school day and the full-time workday. I study how afterschool care affects maternal employment using the staggered rollout of 21st Century Community Learning Center grants. I collect a novel dataset on these grants and build a precise geographic linkage with individuals in restricted-access Census Bureau data. I find that while overall maternal employment does not change, Black and other minority non-Hispanic mothers are 6.2 percentage points more likely to work full time when their nearest elementary school receives a grant. At the same time, women living near these schools are 0.67 percentage points less likely to report working in a care occupation. Among mothers, the decline in care occupation is driven by Hispanic mothers (-1.03 pp). Because mothers both use and provide childcare, understanding its effect on maternal employment requires measuring effects on both.

PUBLICATIONS

"Pandemic Schooling Mode and Student Test Scores: Evidence from US School Districts." (with Clare Halloran, James Okun, and Emily Oster), *American Economic Review: Insights, 5(2),* 2023.

"COVID-19, School Closures, and Outcomes." (with Emily Oster), *Journal of Economic Perspectives,* 2023.

"Gender Salience and Chat-Based Communication in Teams." *AEA Papers and Proceedings,* 2025.

"Effectiveness of Three versus Six Feet of Physical Distancing for Controlling Spread of COVID-19 among Primary and Secondary Students and Staff: A Retrospective, State-Wide Cohort Study." (with Polly van den Berg, Elissa Perkins, Isabella Epshtein, Richard Nelson, Emily Oster, and Westyn Branch-Elliman) *Clinical Infectious Diseases*, 2021.

"Disparities in Learning Mode Access among K–12 Students during the COVID-19 Pandemic, by Race/Ethnicity, Geography, and Grade Level—United States, September 2020–April 2021." (with

Emily Oster, Clare Halloran, John Schoof, Diana McLeod, Haisheng Yang, Julie Roche, and Dennis Roche) *Morbidity and Mortality Weekly Report*, 2021, 70(26), p.953.

WORKING PAPERS

"The Landscape of Parental Leave-Taking in the United States" (with Daniel Tannenbaum and Brenden Timpe) *Revise and resubmit, AEJ: Economic Policy.*

"Sick Days, Snow Days, and the Labor Market Impacts of Caretaking Inequities" (with Garrett Anstreicher)

"The Parenthood Gap: Firms, Flexibility, and Earnings Inequality After Kids" (with Daniel Tannenbaum and Brenden Timpe) *Upjohn Institute working paper*: 25-412, 2025.

"Post COVID-19 Test Score Recovery: Initial Evidence from State Testing Data" (with Clare Halloran, Claire Hug, and Emily Oster) *NBER Working Paper*: 31113, 2023.

"COVID-19 Mitigation Practices and COVID-19 Rates in Schools: Report on Data from Florida, New York and Massachusetts." (with Emily Oster, Clare Halloran, John Schoof, and Diana McLeod) *medRxiv*. 2021.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"The Continuing Impact of COVID-19 School Closures on Teenagers"

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant, co-supported by the Washington Center for Equitable Growth	2026-2027
Buffett Institute Graduate Scholarship	2026-2027
McConnell Fellowship	2026-2027
Gates Foundation, NBER Pre-Doctoral Fellowship Program in Gender in the Economy	2025-2026
UNL College of Business Ph.D. Student Research Award	2024
Bingham Teaching Fellowship	2024-2025
Ogle Fellowship	2021-2025
Othmer Fellowship	2021-2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Daniel Tannenbaum, Dr. Brenden Timpe	2022-present
Research Director, COVID-19 School Data Hub, Dr. Emily Oster	2020-2023
Research Assistant, Dr. Olga Stoddard	2013-2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Introduction to Econometrics, Instructor of Record	2024
Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching Assistant	2022
Honors Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching Assistant	2021

PRESENTATIONS

2026: AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, NBER Gender in the Economy Spring Meeting
2025: AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, W.E. Upjohn Institute seminar
2024: Bozeman Applied Economics Conference, Chicago Fed, SEA Annual Meeting
2023: SEA Annual Meeting, Federal Statistical Research Data Center Annual Research Conference, Nebraska Labor Summit

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Nebraska Labor Summit Committee	2023-present
Economics Graduate Student Activities Organizer, University of Nebraska	2021-2025
Department of Economics Undergraduate Committee, University of Nebraska	2022-2023
Becker Friedman Price Theory Camp, University of Chicago	2023
NBER Health Economics Research Boot Camp	2022

Refereeing: *Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Feminist Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Empirical Economics*

REFERENCES

Emily Oster
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Brown University
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